

Emotions Are Information

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 2
OBJECTIVE	Students name at least five emotions and describe feelings as useful messengers rather than problems to avoid or hide.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: identifying and labeling emotions; emotional expression
VOCABULARY	emotion, feeling, messenger, regulate, identify
MATERIALS	Journals · Emotions anchor chart · Emotion thermometer worksheet · Drawn face images

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Show the identity web from L1. "Last week we mapped who we are. Today we add something — our emotions. What is one emotion you felt since last week?" Take 4–5 responses. "Every one of those feelings — we're going to learn what it's trying to tell you."

1

Hook — Faces Activity

2–7 MIN

Show 4–5 drawn faces. "What might this person be feeling? What might have happened right before?" "Emotions don't appear randomly. They are always a response to something."

ANCHOR CHART · EMOTIONS ARE MESSENGERS

Build WITH students — co-construction increases ownership. Add each emotion as students name it. For each: what message does it carry? This chart stays posted all year.

2

Direct Instruction

7–16 MIN

Every emotion exists for a reason: FEAR = something feels dangerous. SADNESS = something I care about was lost. ANGER = a boundary was crossed. JOY = I am in alignment with what matters. EMBARRASSMENT = I care about belonging. LONELINESS = I need connection. "Emotions are not problems. They are data."

3

Co-build Anchor Chart

16–25 MIN

Push beyond happy/sad/mad: frustrated, proud, embarrassed, relieved, confused, hopeful, lonely, overwhelmed, curious. For each: What might this emotion be trying to tell us?

4

Emotion Thermometer

25–32 MIN

Students fill in their thermometer — from lowest intensity to highest. Name what each level feels like in the body AND what it tells them. Personal — not collected.